

Service Types

In Android 14+, it must specify appropriate foreground service type(s). Multiple types can be combined. Note that additional requirements may exist for each service type.

Foreground service types:

- [camera](#) : i.e.: video chat apps that allow for multitasking
- [connectedDevice](#) : interactions with external devices that require a BT, NFC, IR...
- [dataSync](#) : synchronizing data; mostly replaceable from other APIs
- [health](#) : Any long-running use cases to support apps in the fitness category
- [location](#) : navigation and location sharing, alternatively geofence API
- [mediaPlayback](#) : Continue audio or video playback from the background
- [mediaProjection](#) : Project content to non-primary display or external device
- [microphone](#) : Continue microphone capture from the background
- [phoneCall](#) : Continue an ongoing call
- [remoteMessaging](#) : Transfer text messages from one device to another when device switch occurs
- [shortService](#) : Quickly finish critical work in less than 3 minutes.
- [specialUse](#) : Covers any valid foreground service use cases that aren't covered by the other types
- [systemExempted](#) : Reserved for system applications and specific system integrations

Alternatives for Services in Android APIs

Option[1]	When to use	Timing	Examples
WorkManager	For scheduling tasks with duration less than 10 minutes that should execute when the app is not visible.	Deferrable: Can also be adjusted by constraints Immediate: Use setExpedited if the work needs to run immediately	Periodically syncing data with a server Downloading or uploading media while on the network Background-initiated (not by the user)

User-Initiated Data Transfer Job	When the data transfer is triggered by the user, and we need to keep the user informed about the transfer's progress.	Initiated by the user starts immediately	Uploading a photo, downloading a file
Foreground Service	For short, critical tasks, or when WorkManager is not an option. A notification informs the user of the transfer's progress.	Starts immediately	connectedDevice : Syncing data with a connected device shortService : File processing under 3 minutes mediaProcessing : Encoding or decoding a media file
Specific API	Use if one exists <u>for that particular</u> operation. Can yield benefits such as optimized performance and improved system integration.	Varies	Maintaining a connection with a smart watch [2]

[1] <https://developer.android.com/develop/background-work/background-tasks/data-transfer-options>

[2] <https://developer.android.com/reference/android/companion/CompanionDeviceManager>